METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Privacy & Data Security Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Privacy & Data Security Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Privacy & Data Security is a Key Issue in the Social Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on the amount of personal data they collect, their exposure to evolving or increasing privacy regulations, their vulnerability to potential data breaches, and their systems for protecting personal data.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Loss of revenue or unanticipated remediation and litigation costs in the event of a data breach or misuse.
- Damage to reputation in the event of a breach or controversy over how data is used.
- Loss of significant market or forced change in business model if regulatory action restricts how companies may use data.
- Increased costs to comply with new or evolving regulations.

Privacy & Data Security Key Issue score

The Privacy & Data Security Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score on this Key Issue is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Privacy & Data Security Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Privacy & Data Security Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

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Component	Sustainability Indicator
Privacy & Data Security Core Risk Management score	Scope of employee training on privacy and data security
	Responsibility for privacy and data security
	Measures to address data breaches
	Frequency of audits of information security system
	Rights provided to consumers regarding the control of their data
	Scope of data protection policy
Privacy & Data Security Supplemental Risk Management score	Scope of information security management system certifications
	Privacy enhancing technologies and initiatives
	Consent policy for use of consumer data for secondary purposes
	Data protection programs covering suppliers and business partners

Privacy & Data Security Management score

The Privacy & Data Security Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Privacy & Data Security Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

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The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Privacy & Data Security Core Risk Management score

The Privacy & Data Security Core Risk Management score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage core privacy and data security risks through policies, consumer rights, breach response, audits, oversight, and employee training. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Scope of employee training on privacy and data security**

Definition The coverage of privacy and data security training across the workforce. Best practice is for training to be provided to all employees, including contractors.

- **Responsibility for privacy and data security**

Definition: The group (board-level committee, C-suite or executive committee, or special task force or risk officer) responsible for the company's privacy and data security risk and strategy.

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- **Measures to address data breaches**

Definition: The scope of the data breach or incident response plan the company has in place, including whether the plan is proactive, reactive or limited in scope.

- **Frequency of audits of information security system**

Definition: The frequency with which the company audits its information security policies and systems.

- **Rights provided to consumers regarding the control of their data**

Definition: The extent of the rights provided by the company to individuals regarding the access, rectification and deletion of individuals' data.

- **Scope of data protection policy**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's data protection policy governs all or selected business lines. A data protection policy must contain at least the following basic provisions: (1) clarifying collection purposes, (2) clarifying the means by which the company collects data, and (3) clarifying whether third parties have access to data and for what purposes.

Privacy & Data Security Supplemental Risk Management score

The Privacy & Data Security Supplemental Risk Management score evaluates the company's initiatives to strengthen privacy and data security beyond core policies, through consent practices, privacy-enhancing technologies, supplier requirements, and security certifications. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Scope of information security management system certifications**

Definition: The scope of the company's information security management system certification to widely recognized standards. Best practice is for most (over 80%) of owned operations to be certified to widely recognized standards, such as ISO 27001, TRUSTe, Privacy Mark and SSAE16 soc2.

- **Privacy enhancing technologies and initiatives**

Definition: Assesses the company's practice on integrating privacy-enhancing technologies and initiatives into its products or services. Best practices include systematically applying the privacy-by-

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design principle during product or service development, and conducting privacy impact assessments on existing offerings before introducing new ones.

- **Consent policy for use of consumer data for secondary purposes**

Definition: Assesses the company's policy or practice regarding the processing customer data for secondary purposes and the consent options provided to customers, such as opt-in or opt-out mechanisms.

- **Data protection programs covering suppliers and business partners**

Definition: The extent of the company's data protection or privacy programs covering suppliers and business partners that handle the company's data or have access to the company's network. Best practice is for them to be required to have data protection policies or abide by the company's policy and for inspections to be conducted to verify their compliance.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Privacy and data security controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Privacy & Data Security Exposure score

The Privacy & Data Security Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the product of the Business Exposure score and Company-Specific Exposure multiplier, combined with the Geographic Exposure score. The Geographic Exposure score functions as a multiplier on the Business Exposure score and Company Specific Exposure multiplier, with an impact ranging from -50% to +50%. The Business Exposure score and Geographic Exposure score are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

$$EXP_{PDS,i} = \left(BUS_{PDS,i} * COM_{PDS,i}\right)\left(1 + 0.1\left(GEO_{PDS,i} - 5\right)\right)$$

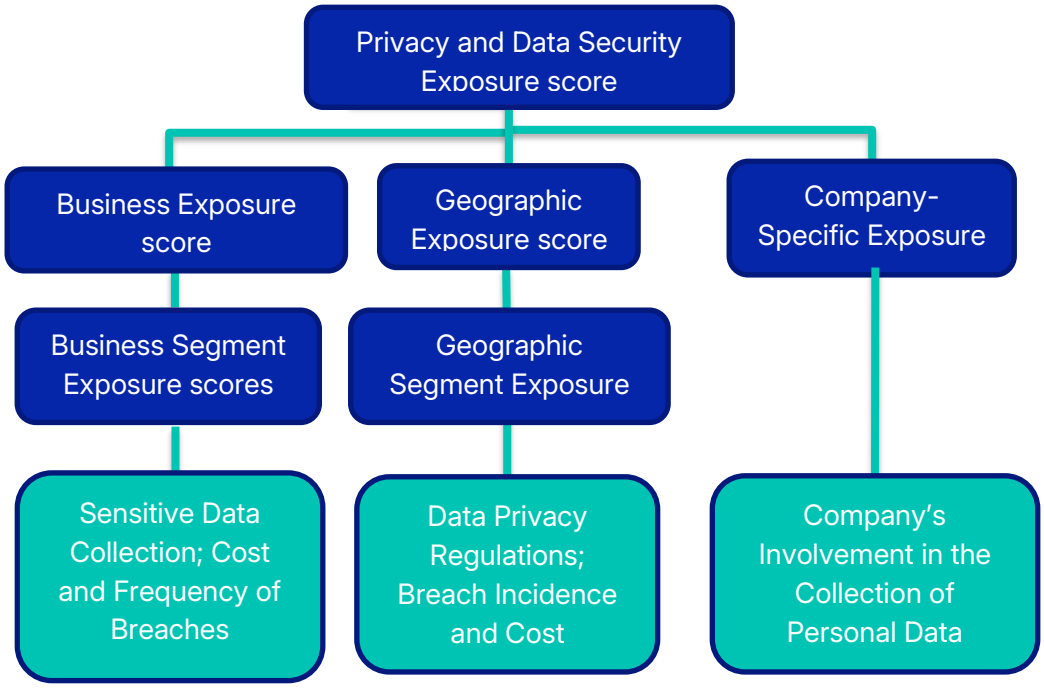
Where:

- $EXP_{PDS,i}$ is the Privacy & Data Security Exposure score of company i.

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- $BUS_{PDS,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $COM_{PDS,i}$ is the Company-Specific Exposure multiplier of company i.
- $GEO_{PDS,i}$ is the Geographic Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Exposure scores of a company's business segments. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each business segment, using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{PDS,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,j} BSE_{PDS,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{PDS,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

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Business Segment Exposure scores

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by the business activity's sensitivity to data breaches and certain characteristics of its data breaches, using the following formula:

$$BSE_{PDS,j} = \frac{SEN_j + DB_j}{2}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{PDS,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- SEN_j is the Sensitivity score for business activity j.
- DB_j is the Data Breach score for business activity j.

The Sensitivity score of a business activity is determined by a qualitative assessment of the following factors.

- Handling of sensitive data such as Social Security numbers, dates of birth, financial account information, health data or locations.
- Involvement in business activities such as selling advertising or selling access to user data.

The Data Breach score of a business activity is calculated as the average of the Breach Frequency score and the Breach Cost score, as shown below:

$$DB_j = \frac{BF_j + BC_j}{2}$$

Where:

- DB_j is the Data Breach score for business activity j.
- BF_j is the Breach Frequency score for business activity j.
- BC_j is the Breach Cost score for business activity j.

The Breach Frequency score indicates the ratio of total breach incidents as a proportion of average sales in the business activity. The Breach Cost score indicates the cost of data breaches per lost or stolen

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record in a business activity. Both these indicators are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk.

Geographic Exposure score

The Geographic Exposure score is a weighted average of the Geographic Segment Exposure scores of the countries, markets and regions in which a company operates. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each geographic segment through the following equation:

$$GEO_{PDS,i} = \sum_{r=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,r} GSE_{PDS,r}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{PDS,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score in region r.
- $w_{Revenue,i,r}$ is the weight of total revenue in region r for company i.
- n_i is the number of geographic segments for company i.

For geographic segments disclosed as regions (example: Asia Pacific), a nominal GDP-weighted country or market aggregation is used to calculate region-level scores, using the following equation:

$$GSE_{PDS,r} = \sum_{c=1}^{n_r} w_{GDP,r,c} GSE_{PDS,c}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{PDS,c}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of country or market c.
- $w_{GDP,r,c}$ is the specific weight of country or market c within region r.

Geographic Segment Exposure scores

The Geographic Segment Exposure score is determined by assessing a country or market's privacy and data security regulation and certain characteristics of its data breaches, using the following formula:

$$GSE_{PDS,c} = \frac{REG_c + DB_c}{2}$$

Where:

- REG_c is the Regulatory score for country or market c.
- DB_c is the Data Breach score for country or market c.

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The Regulatory score of a country is determined by a qualitative assessment of the following factors:

- Level of restriction in national privacy and data security regulation relative to global standards.
- Likelihood of regulatory change in the next few years.

The Data Breach score of a country or market is the average of the Breach Incidence score and the Breach Cost per Company score, as shown below.

$$DB_c = \frac{BI_c + BCC_c}{2}$$

Where:

- DB_c is the Data Breach score for country or market c.
- BI_c is the Breach Incidence score for country or market c.
- BCC_c is the Breach Cost per Company score for country or market c.

The Breach Incidence score indicates the total number of breaches recorded in the country, market or region. The Breach Cost per Company score indicates the average cost incurred per company operating in the country, market or region.

The Data Breach score, Breach Incidence score and Breach Cost per Company score are measured on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk.

Company-Specific Exposure score

The Company Specific Exposure score is calculated based on whether the company is involved in the collection of personal data.

If a company is involved in the collection of personal data the company specific exposure score is 10, and the company specific exposure multiplier is:

$$COM_{PDS,k} = 1$$

Where:

- $COM_{PDS,k}$ is the Company-Specific Exposure multiplier of company k.

If a company is not involved in the collection of personal data, , the company specific exposure score is 0 , and the company specific exposure multiplier is:

$$COM_{PDS,k} = 0.5$$

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Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Privacy & Data Security Exposure score:

Ponemon Institute and IBM's Cost of a Data Breach report series, Verizon's Data Breach Investigations Report, Refinitiv, MSCI S&C, company disclosures.

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